

How to Upload a Distribution Grid

Chainlink Analytics User Guide

The Distribution Grid upload is how you tell Chainlink which products are authorized at each store for a given chain. This guide walks you through downloading the template, filling it in, formatting it, and uploading it to the system. The whole process takes just a few minutes.

Before You Start

Make sure you have your chain's distribution grid data ready — either as a standard column file or a pivot-style file. You will need:

- The store numbers for the chain you are uploading
- The UPC codes for each authorized product
- Whether each product is in schematic at each store (Yes = 1, No = 0)

Step-by-Step Instructions

Step 1 — Navigate to Format & Upload

- Log into Chainlink Analytics
- Click Format & Upload in the left navigation menu
- Select Distribution Grid from the tabs at the top

Step 2 — Download the Template

- Click Standard Distro Grid Template or Pivot Distro Grid Template
- The template will download to your computer as an Excel file
- Standard template has 3 columns: STORE_NUMBER, UPC, PRODUCT_NAME, YES_NO
- Pivot template has UPC and Name columns, with store numbers across the top

■ *PRODUCT_NAME is for your reference only — Chainlink will automatically update it from the product catalog after upload.*

Step 3 — Fill In Your Data

- Open the downloaded template in Excel
- Fill in STORE_NUMBER with the chain's store numbers
- Fill in UPC with the 11 or 12-digit product barcode
- Set YES_NO to 1 if the product is in schematic, 0 if it is not
- Do not add, remove, or rename any columns
- Save the file when done

Step 4 — Select Your Chain and Format

- Back in Chainlink, select your chain from the dropdown (e.g. Save Mart)
- Select Standard Column Format or Pivot Format to match your file
- Click Choose File and select your completed Excel file
- Click Format Now
- Chainlink will verify your store numbers and show a confirmation

■ *If you see a store number mismatch warning, check that you selected the correct chain. Chainlink will suggest the chain that best matches your store numbers.*

Step 5 — Upload to the Database

- After formatting, click Download Formatted Grid to save the formatted file
- In the Upload section, select your chain and upload the formatted file
- Click Upload Distribution Grid to Database
- Chainlink will confirm the number of records uploaded

Step 6 — Verify Your Upload

- Navigate to Reports to confirm your data appears correctly
- Check that store names, counties, and manufacturer names are populated
- If anything looks wrong, contact your Chainlink administrator

Need Help?

Contact Randy Griggs Sr. at Chainlink Analytics for assistance with your distribution grid upload.